

Comcast Corporation

Recommendation **BUY** ★★★★★

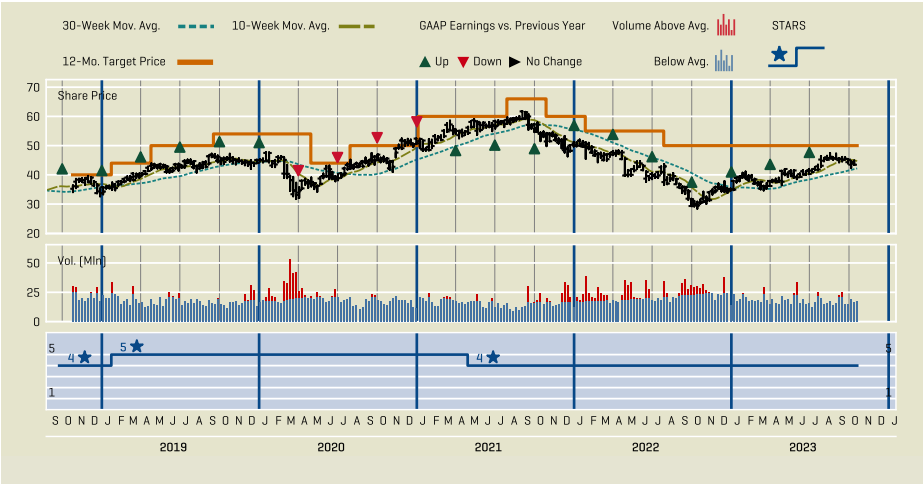
Price USD 42.86 [as of market close Oct 20, 2023] 12-Mo. Target Price USD 50.00 Report Currency USD Investment Style Large-Cap Value

Equity Analyst Keith Snyder

GICS Sector Communication Services Sub-Industry Cable and Satellite Summary This media conglomerate has diversified interests in cable and broadcasting television, filmed entertainment, and theme parks, as well as satellite TV broadcasting.

Key Stock Statistics [Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports]									
52-Wk Range	USD 47.45 - 30.04	Oper.EPS2023E	USD 3.75	Market Capitalization[B]	USD 176.8	Beta	0.99		
Trailing 12-Month EPS	USD 3.83	Oper.EPS2024E	USD 4.16	Yield [%]	2.71	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	8		
Trailing 12-Month P/E	11.19	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	11.43	Dividend Rate/Share	USD 1.16	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	A-		
USD 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	13,370.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	4,132.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	USD 1.14	Institutional Ownership [%]	86.0		

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by Keith Snyder on Aug 07, 2023 03:03 PM ET, when the stock traded at USD 45.53.

Highlights

- ▶ We project consolidated revenue of \$120.3 billion in 2023, a decrease of about 1.0% after a 4.3% increase in the prior year, which reflected contributions from the FIFA World Cup. We see a continued rebound at the NBCU division, with a full reopening of the worldwide theme parks and the studio pipelines combined with growth in TV distribution and ad revenue. At the cable division, we see continued growth in broadband and wireless subscribers (versus further losses of video and voice customers). We project revenue growth of 2.7% to \$123.5 billion in 2024.
- ▶ We forecast EBITDA margin of 31.1% in 2023 and 31.6% in 2024—versus 30.1% in 2022—with favorable mix shifts to high-margin connectivity businesses as well as growth in high-speed data and business services. This will likely be partly offset by ratcheted costs of entertainment and sports programming combined with start-up losses for Peacock (streaming platform) and wireless-related costs.
- ▶ After depreciation, amortization, and interest, with a projected effective tax rate of 24%-26% and some share buybacks, we forecast EPS of \$3.75 in 2023 and \$4.16 in 2024.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- ▶ Our Buy opinion partly reflects further upside on the valuation of the shares, with the integration of the cable, NBCU, and Sky businesses likely to enhance business and geographic diversification. We think Comcast's results in the first half of 2023 showed a firming recovery path for NBCU's advertising, TV/film content, and theme parks businesses—benefiting from pent-up demand. Meanwhile, with the cable broadband business recently riding some demand tailwinds, the company has increasingly pivoted to a broadband-led connectivity strategy and gained significant traction in its nascent wireless offering. With likely sufficient financial flexibility, Comcast could sustain at least a high-single-digit return on invested capital (ROIC) in the years ahead, by our analysis.
- ▶ Risks to our opinion and target price include potential uncertainties with the full impact and/or duration of the Covid-19 pandemic; intensifying competition from over-the-top video platforms; regulatory risk factors [Net Neutrality, etc.]; and currency exposure.
- ▶ Our 12-month target price is \$50, with a total EV/EBITDA of 8.1x our 2023 estimate, roughly in line with peers. The stock recently offered a 2.6% dividend yield.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW MEDIUM HIGH

Our risk assessment reflects potentially large economies of scale resulting from vertical and horizontal acquisitions that have proven transformative over the past several years, combined with a strong management team that has a long track record of successful execution. In addition, we see risks to Comcast's broadband business from the entrance of fixed wireless network offerings from T-Mobile and Verizon. Also, this is against a backdrop of industry-wide concerns about escalating programming costs, intensifying competition from rival pay-TV and "over-the-top" video platforms, and regulatory risk factors.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	--	--	--	--	E 123,490
2023	29,691	30,513	--	--	E 120,329
2022	29,204	28,157	29,627	31,128	118,801
2021	27,091	26,642	29,045	29,555	111,977
2020	26,609	23,715	25,532	26,786	102,935
2019	26,859	26,858	26,827	28,398	108,942

Earnings Per Share (USD)					
	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	Year
2024	E 1.02	E 1.09	E 1.05	E 1.00	E 4.16
2023	0.92	1.13	E 0.95	E 0.82	E 3.75
2022	0.86	1.01	0.96	0.82	3.64
2021	0.76	0.84	0.87	0.77	3.23
2020	0.71	0.69	0.65	0.56	2.61
2019	0.76	0.78	0.79	0.79	3.13

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [USD]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.2900	Jul 27	Oct 03	Oct 04	Oct 25 '23
0.2900	May 17	Jul 03	Jul 05	Jul 26 '23
0.2900	Jan 21	Apr 04	Apr 05	Apr 26 '23
0.2700	Oct 11	Jan 03	Jan 04	Jan 25 '23

Dividends have been paid since 1977 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.



Comcast Corporation

Business Summary Aug 07, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW. Comcast is the largest U.S. cable system operator with more than 34.3 million customer relationships as of December 31, 2022. The cable communications segment [55% of 2022 consolidated revenues and 78% of total segment adjusted EBITDA], which mainly caters to residential [as well as business] customers, recently had the following subscribers for its various products: video, 15.6 million; high-speed data, 29.8 million; voice, 7.9 million; and wireless, 5.3 million. The cable division also includes Comcast Interactive Media, comprising Comcast.net, Fancast, thePlatform, and Fandango.

The Media segment [20% and 8%] consists primarily of NBCUniversal’s television and streaming platforms, including national, regional, and international cable networks; the NBC and Telemundo broadcast networks, NBC- and Telemundo-owned local broadcast television stations; and Peacock. The segment includes several leading cable networks [USA, E!, CNBC, MSNBC, Bravo, Oxygen, Syfy, Versus, Golf Channel, and Style] as well as 12 regional sports and news networks, plus owned-and-operated TV stations.

The Studios segment [2% and 1%] consists primarily of NBCUniversal’s film and television studio production and distribution operations. The Theme Parks segment [7% and 6%] consists primarily of its Universal theme parks in Orlando, Florida; Hollywood, California; Osaka, Japan; and Beijing, China. The Sky segment [16% and 7%] consists of the operations of Sky, one of Europe’s leading entertainment companies, which primarily includes a direct-to-consumer business, providing video, broadband, voice and wireless phone services, and a content business, operating entertainment networks, the Sky News broadcast network, and Sky Sports networks.

After an initial 2011 acquisition of a 51% controlling stake in NBC Universal [NBCU] in a USD37.25 billion transaction, the company secured full NBCU ownership in February 2013 upon redeeming GE’s remaining stake for USD16.7 billion. In 2012, Comcast divested NBCU’s 15.8% stake in A&E TV networks—including A&E, Lifetime, History, and Biography channels—for about USD2.3 billion in cash proceeds.

In July 2020, the company’s NBCU division launched a new streaming offering based on a hybrid advertising-supported and subscriptions business model. As of late-January 2021, the service had garnered about 33 million sign-ups.

IMPACT OF MAJOR DEVELOPMENTS. In October 2018, Comcast acquired Sky, a Pan-European satellite television broadcaster. This followed an auction for Sky in September—presided by the U.K. Takeover Panel—during which Comcast outbid Disney [DIS 86 ****] and Fox [FOXA 33 ***] for control of Sky. Comcast’s winning bid was GBP17.28 a share, valuing the Pan-European satellite TV broadcaster at GBP30.2 billion [USD39.5 billion], some 17% higher than its earlier offer in July and 10% above the final offer from Disney/Fox. Following Comcast’s winning bid, Disney/Fox also agreed to sell its 39% minority stake in Sky to Comcast, which thereafter acquired full control.

Separately, in June 2018, Comcast launched a USD65 billion all-cash bid for the entertainment assets of Twenty-First Century Fox, topping Disney’s initial all-stock bid of USD52.4 billion in December 2017 for the same assets. However, in July, Comcast dropped its bid for those assets after it was topped by Disney’s revised bid of USD71.3 billion in cash and stock.

Earlier, in August 2016, the company acquired DreamWorks Animation, a previously independent film studio, for about USD3.8 billion in cash. In April 2015, amid regulatory opposition, the company terminated an earlier agreement to acquire Time Warner Cable, the second-largest U.S. cable operator with more than 11 million subscribers, for an equity valuation of about USD45 billion [or an enterprise value of USD67 billion including debt] in a proposed stock-for-stock transaction.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE. On the cable distribution side, the company competes primarily with satellite TV companies DirecTV Group and DISH Network as well as large telcos, such as Verizon Communications and AT&T that have recently deployed fiber-based video and broadband services in head-to-head competition with cable’s triple-play bundle. Also, these traditional pay-TV providers are facing increased competition from streaming video platforms such as Netflix, Hulu, Amazon Video, and YouTube TV, as well from others such as Sling TV, CBS All Access, and recent upstarts such as Disney+, Apple TV+, HBO Max, and Peacock. On the NBCU side, the company primarily competes with other media conglomerates with significant interests in cable and broadcast TV networks/stations, and film/TV studios, including Disney, Time Warner, CBS, Viacom, and Sony.

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE. The company has three classes of shares, namely “B,” “A,” and “A Special.” The class B [super-voting and non-trading] and A shares are entitled to 15 votes and 0.1373 votes per share, respectively, while the A Special shares are not entitled to vote. All of the class B shares are held by the Roberts family, including CEO Brian Roberts [and company founder Ralph Roberts]. As of April 2019, CEO Brian Roberts, through his ownership of the entire “B” shares, controlled approximately one-third of the combined voting power of the two classes of stock.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. By the end of 2022, the company generated a five-year compound annual growth rate [CAGR] in revenue and EBITDA of 6.6% and 5.6%, respectively. Meanwhile, the company’s adjusted EBITDA margin was 30.0% in 2022 versus 29.7% in 2021 and 29.5% in 2020. In 2022, the company generated about USD13.2 billion of free cash flow. That compared to its free cash flow of USD15.5 billion in 2021. As of December 31, 2022, total debt amounted to USD98.2 billion, with about USD12.7 billion of cash and equivalents.

Corporate information

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Office One Comcast Center, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, 19103-2838	
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Fax N/A	
Website corporate.comcast.com	
Officers	
Chairman & CEO B. L. Roberts	President M. J. Cavanagh
Executive VP, Chief Accounting Officer & Controller D. C. Murdock	Chief Financial Officer J. S. Armstrong
Operations Director M. Lindsley	Chief Legal Officer & Secretary T. J. Reid
Chief Technology Officer M. Zelesko	
Board Members	
A. Nakahara	J. J. Collins
B. L. Roberts	J. Rodin
C. Conde	K. J. Bacon
D. C. Novak	L. F. Brady
D. J. Hilferty	M. G. Montiel
D. Langley	M. H. Lazarus
E. D. Breen	M. S. Bell
F. A. Shabel	M. Woodbury
G. L. Hassell	P. Igbokwe
J. A. Honickman	T. J. Baltimore
Domicile Pennsylvania	
Auditor Deloitte & Touche LLP	
Founded 1963	
Employees 186,000	
Stockholders 336,649	



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Quantitative Evaluations					
Fair Value Rank	1	2	3	4	5
	LOWEST		HIGHEST		
	Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).				
Fair Value Calculation	USD 37.59	Analysis of the stock's current worth, based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model suggests that CMCSA is overvalued by USD 5.27 or 12.30%			
Volatility	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH
Technical Evaluation	NEUTRAL	Since August, 2023, the technical indicators for CMCSA have been NEUTRAL"			
Insider Activity	UNFAVORABLE	NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE	

Expanded Ratio Analysis				
	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	1.28	2.01	2.34	1.90
Price/EBITDA	4.25	6.77	7.92	6.08
Price/Pretax Income	16.69	12.27	17.23	12.20
P/E Ratio	9.61	15.58	20.08	14.37
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	4,430.00	4,654.00	4,624.00	4,610.00
Figures based on fiscal year-end price				

Key Growth Rates and Averages				
Past Growth Rate [%]		1 Year	3 Years	5 Years
Net Income		NM	NM	NM
Sales		4.33	3.68	7.39
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)				
Net Margin [%]		4.42	8.92	10.23
% LT Debt to Capitalization		51.08	49.53	51.72
Return on Equity [%]		5.47	10.65	13.02

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31										
Per Share Data (USD)	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	-15.69	-14.79	-16.40	-17.90	-20.39	-9.83	-12.35	-11.67	-10.03	-10.19
Free Cash Flow	2.80	3.52	2.44	2.67	2.65	2.13	1.86	1.93	1.63	1.25
Earnings	1.21	3.04	2.28	2.83	2.53	4.75	1.78	1.62	1.60	1.28
Earnings (Normalized)	3.64	3.23	2.61	3.13	2.55	2.06	1.74	1.62	1.46	1.24
Dividends	1.08	1.00	0.92	0.84	0.76	0.63	0.55	0.50	0.45	0.39
Payout Ratio [%]	88.29	32.01	39.30	28.61	28.57	12.68	29.97	29.85	26.90	28.81
Prices: High	52.10	61.80	52.49	47.27	44.00	42.18	35.66	32.50	29.65	26.04
Prices: Low	28.39	46.29	31.70	33.30	30.43	34.12	26.17	25.00	23.87	18.15
P/E Ratio: High	14.30	19.10	20.10	15.10	17.30	20.50	20.50	20.00	20.20	21.10
P/E Ratio: Low	7.80	14.30	12.10	10.60	11.90	16.60	15.00	15.40	16.30	14.70
Income Statement Analysis (Million USD)										
Revenue	121,427	116,385	103,564	108,942	94,507	85,029	80,736	74,510	68,775	64,657
Operating Income	22,624	20,817	17,493	21,125	19,148	17,576	16,892	15,998	15,141	13,563
Depreciation + Amortization	13,821	13,804	13,100	12,953	11,017	10,130	9,426	8,680	8,019	7,871
Interest Expense	3,896	4,281	4,588	4,567	3,542	3,086	2,942	2,702	2,617	2,574
Pretax Income	9,284	19,093	14,065	16,996	15,242	15,353	14,326	13,372	12,465	11,115
Effective Tax Rate	47.00	27.50	23.90	21.60	22.20	-49.30	37.00	37.10	31.10	35.80
Net Income	5,370	14,159	10,534	13,057	11,731	22,735	8,678	8,163	8,380	6,816
Net Income (Normalized)	11,812	12,046	7,990	9,947	9,599	9,143	8,567	7,721	7,710	6,716
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data (Million USD)										
Cash	4,749	8,711	11,740	7,100	3,814	3,428	5,073	2,316	4,512	5,291
Current Assets	21,826	24,807	26,741	25,392	21,848	16,343	16,361	12,303	13,531	14,075
Total Assets	257,275	275,905	273,869	263,414	251,684	187,462	180,500	166,574	159,186	158,813
Current Liabilities	27,887	29,348	28,796	30,292	27,603	21,993	21,535	18,178	17,410	18,912
Long Term Debt	96,440	96,188	104,521	102,931	107,345	59,422	55,566	48,994	43,864	44,567
Total Capital	188,803	205,268	206,404	197,235	185,561	135,372	118,666	107,820	102,215	99,862
Capital Expenditures	10,956	10,150	10,677	11,069	10,234	9,621	9,157	8,499	7,420	6,596
Cash from Operations	26,413	29,146	24,737	25,697	24,297	21,261	19,691	19,485	16,945	14,160
Current Ratio	0.78	0.85	0.93	0.84	0.79	0.74	0.76	0.68	0.78	0.74
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization	51.10	46.90	50.60	52.20	57.80	43.90	46.80	45.40	42.90	44.60
% Net Income of Revenue	4.40	12.20	10.20	12.00	12.40	26.70	10.70	11.00	12.20	10.50
% Return on Assets	5.30	4.73	4.07	5.13	5.45	5.97	6.08	6.14	5.95	5.24
% Return on Equity	5.50	14.50	12.00	16.80	16.40	35.70	16.00	15.40	16.20	12.00

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Comcast Corporation

Sub-Industry Outlook

Our neutral fundamental outlook on the cable and satellite TV sub-industry over the next year partly reflects increased pressures in the overall television ecosystem as more consumers opt out of traditional pay-TV packages and into cheaper online alternatives, even as the Covid-19 lockdown provided some structural tailwinds for the residential broadband business. Also, we see some lingering uncertainties regarding certain aspects of the FCC's broadband regulations. Meanwhile, the sub-industry is coming off a major wave of consolidation following a notable increase in the volume of M&A activity in recent years.

Recent years have witnessed increased pressure on pay-TV subscriber growth (or subscriber losses), coinciding with the increased popularity of streaming video (over-the-top) outlets such as Netflix, Amazon Prime Video, Hulu, HBO Now, and CBS All Access. Also, a number of virtual pay-TV providers (digital MVPDs) have joined the fray to offer their own "skinny" cable packages, partly aimed at millennials and the so-called "cord-cutters" or "cord nevers."

Nonetheless, we expect continued penetration of advanced video services such as 4K/UHD (ultra-high-definition), amid a continued "battle of the bundles" among pay-TV providers: cable, satellite TV, and telcos. After a recently-completed all-digital migration, cable providers are now focused on cloud-based applications and other product enhancements, such as ultra-fast broadband speeds and WiFi-based offerings for in-home and out-of-home access. Also, several operators have recently rolled out wireless/mobile phone services under reseller arrangements with wireless carriers.

Looking ahead, we think the continued deployment of mobile video and broadband offerings will provide the next battlefield among pay-TV companies, many of which have recently launched bundled wireless offerings under resale agreements with wireless network operators. After several rounds of the FCC's auctions of wireless spectrum over the past several years — including the C-Band auction in 2022 — the competitive landscape would be further reshaped by a

continued rollout of next-generation broadband offerings.

Under the Biden administration, a Democrat majority at the FCC could revive the Title II (common carrier) rules under which broadband is regulated as a plain-old telecom service. Biden's FCC will likely revive the so-called Net Neutrality (Open Internet) rules — repealed by the Trump Administration — which could pose some constraints for broadband Internet Service Providers (ISPs) including cable operators.

Meanwhile, valuations reflect a recent wave of strategic M&A activity, in many cases driven by potential economies of scale on vertical and horizontal combinations. Such notable transactions in recent years include AT&T/Time Warner, AT&T/DIRECTV, and Comcast/NBCU, as well as Charter/Time Warner Cable and Bright House Networks. Of course, a Democrat-led FCC majority under the Biden administration could jettison the so-called UHF discount, reversing its recent reinstatement under the Trump administration, which could effectively dampen the overall climate for M&A activity for the local television station groups.

Year-to-date through September 29, the S&P Cable & Satellite sub-industry increased 25.0% compared to a 10.9% increase for the S&P Composite 1500. In 2022, the S&P Cable & Satellite sub-industry Index fell 36.2% compared to a 19.1% decline for the S&P Composite 1500 Index.

/ Keith Snyder

Industry Performance

GICS Sector: Communication Services
Sub-Industry: Cable and Satellite

Based on S&P 1500 Indexes
Five-Year market price performance through Oct 21, 2023



NOTE: A sector chart appears when the sub-industry does not have sufficient historical index data.
All Sector & Sub-Industry information is based on the Global Industry Classification Standard (GICS).
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence

Sub-Industry: Cable and Satellite Peer Group*: Cable and Satellite												
Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
Comcast Corporation	CMCSA	NasdaqGS	USD	43.07	177,669.0	-5.8	41.7	11.0	37.59	2.7	6.9	50.6
Altice USA, Inc.	ATUS	NYSE	USD	3.00	1,364.0	-8.8	-46.0	NM	N/A	N/A	-5.3	95.5
Cable One, Inc.	CABO	NYSE	USD	625.41	3,516.0	-1.4	-19.8	34.0	N/A	1.9	5.8	67.2
Charter Communications, Inc.	CHTR	NasdaqGS	USD	435.87	65,237.0	-3.1	34.3	15.0	601.71	N/A	38.8	85.5
Cogeco Communications Inc.	CGEA.F	OTCPK	USD	43.21	2,623.0	-10.4	-8.7	7.0	N/A	5.4	13.6	59.0
DISH Network Corporation	DISH	NasdaqGS	USD	4.95	2,643.0	-23.6	-64.0	2.0	2.48	N/A	10.3	46.3
Liberty Broadband Corporation	LBRD.K	NasdaqGS	USD	91.10	13,316.0	-1.6	21.3	17.0	N/A	N/A	9.1	30.6
Sirius XM Holdings Inc.	SIRI	NasdaqGS	USD	4.56	17,521.0	9.1	-25.7	15.0	4.33	2.1	-34.5	133.4
The Liberty SiriusXM Group	LSXM.K	NasdaqGS	USD	25.23	8,239.0	9.9	-37.6	10.0	N/A	N/A	9.3	48.2
WideOpenWest, Inc.	WOW	NYSE	USD	7.05	570.0	-9.4	-46.7	NM	N/A	N/A	-30.8	64.9

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.
NA- Not Available; NM- Not Meaningful.
Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Comcast Corporation

Analyst Research Notes and other Company News

July 28, 2023

03:45 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 45.19****]:

We keep our 12-month target price at \$50, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.1x to our '23 estimate, a slight premium to peers, reflecting our higher growth outlook. We raise our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.11 to \$3.75 and increase '24's by \$0.10 to \$4.16. CMCSA reported Q2 operating EPS of \$1.13 vs \$1.01, \$0.15 higher than the consensus. Q2 revenue increased 1.7%, with 8.2% growth in Residential Connectivity, supported by 20.4% growth in wireless and 25.9% growth in international connectivity, a 4.0% increase in Content and Experiences, driven by 22.4% growth in theme parks, partially offset by a 0.9% decline in Studios, with 65.9% growth in theatrical, driven by the release of The Super Mario Bros. Movie and Fast X, offset by a 19.8% drop in content licensing. Wireless remains a bright spot, with 316k net adds, while broadband net losses were 19k, ahead of our expectations as we think the company is handling the low growth broadband environment well. / Keith Snyder

April 28, 2023

04:28 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 41.37****]:

We keep our 12-month target price at \$50, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.4x to our 2023 estimate, roughly in line with its five-year historical average multiple at 8.5x, reflecting recent solid results. We trim our 2023 EPS estimate by \$0.11 to \$3.64 and lower 2024's by \$0.01 to \$4.06. CMCSA reported Q1 operating EPS of \$0.92 vs. \$0.86, \$0.09 above the consensus. Q1 revenue fell 4.3% driven by a 9.5% drop in the Content and Experiences segment due to a 20.7% decline in media on tough comps with the prior period [which included the Olympics and the Super Bowl], and a 0.7% decline in the Residential Connectivity segment. This was partially offset by 1.7% growth in the Studios segment and a 46.0% increase in the Theme Parks segment. Broadband net adds of 5k were better than expected considering comments by management, and we expect this figure to turn negative next quarter. Video net losses were 614k, as the cord cutting trend continues to accelerate, while wireless net adds were 355k. / Keith Snyder

January 26, 2023

05:22 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 40.41****]:

We keep our 12-month target price at \$50, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.6x to our '23 estimate, comparable to its three-year historical average multiple at 8.7x, reflecting recent strong results. We trim our '23 EPS estimate by \$0.09 to \$3.75 and set '24's at \$4.07. CMCSA reported Q4 operating EPS of \$0.82 vs. \$0.77, \$0.04 above the consensus. Q4 revenue increased 0.7%, with 1.4% growth in the Cable segment, driven by a 5.4% increase in broadband on ARPU growth and a 24.7% increase in wireless as well as 5.9% growth in the NBCUniversal segment, with 13.1% growth in studio revenue on higher content licensing and theatrical revenue, a 12.0% increase in theme parks, and 2.6% growth in media, driven entirely by the FIFA World Cup [ex-FIFA, media declined 1.9%]. Wireless reported an impressive 365k net adds, a record, while in the Cable segment, broadband net losses were 26k, driven in part by hurricane Ian in Florida, while video net losses were 440k. / Keith Snyder

October 28, 2022

04:53 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 31.95****]:

We keep our 12-month target price at \$50, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.3x to our '23 estimate, comparable to the peer average, reflecting recent strong results. We raise our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.03 to \$3.61 and trim '23's by \$0.16 to \$3.84. CMCSA reported Q3 operating EPS of \$0.96 vs \$0.87, \$0.06 above the consensus. Q3 revenue declined 1.5%, reflecting tough comps due to the Tokyo Summer Olympics and headwinds from currency translation at Sky and its international theme parks, partially offset by 2.6% growth in its Cable business, driven by a 5.7% increase in broadband revenue due to higher APRU and a 31% increase in wireless, driven by service revenue growth. CMCSA reported 14k broadband net adds, driven by a back-to-school tailwind, while also adding an impressive 330k wireless customers, a record for the company. We view these results as very strong considering Q2 results and believe shares are undervalued at current levels. / Keith Snyder

July 28, 2022

06:23 PM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 39.41****]:

We trim our 12-month target price by \$5 to \$50, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 8.2x to our '23 estimate, a slight discount to its ten-year historical average multiple at 8.9x, reflecting our concerns over competitive pressure in the cable space. We trim our '22 EPS estimate by \$0.01 to \$3.58 and raise our '23 estimate by \$0.02 to \$4.00. CMCSA reported Q2 operating EPS of \$1.01 vs. \$0.84, \$0.09 above the consensus. Q2 revenue increased 5.1%, driven by 18.7% growth in NBCUniversal, on a 33.3% increase in studio revenue as well as 64.8% growth in theme parks, and 3.7% growth in Cable Communications, with 29.8% growth in wireless on 317k net mobile additions, partially offset by a 13.8% decline in Sky due to lower direct to consumer and advertising revenue. We are concerned with the flat growth in total cable customer relationships as the company faces increased competition from both fixed wireless access offerings and the resurgence of mobile substitution for internet access. / Keith Snyder

April 29, 2022

10:54 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Opinion on Shares of Comcast Corporation [CMCSA 40.24****]:

We keep our 12-month target at \$55, applying an EV/EBITDA multiple of 9.1x to our '22 estimate, in line with peers, reflecting recent results. We trim our '22 EPS by \$0.11 to \$3.59 and lower '23's by \$0.21 to \$3.98. CMCSA reported Q1 operating EPS of \$0.86 vs. \$0.76, \$0.05 above the consensus. Q1 revenue increased 14%, driven by a 46.6% increase in NBCUniversal on 151.9% growth in theme parks due to easy comps created by Covid-19-related shutdowns in the prior period and a 4.7% increase in the Cable Communications segment. This was driven by increases in broadband, business services, wireless, and advertising, partially offset by a 0.5% decline in Sky on lower content revenue. Broadband net adds slowed to 262k, with the company noting that roughly one-third of net adds represent subs who had temporary been receiving its services for free under pandemic-related programs. We expect net adds to continue slowing in the upcoming quarters due to competitive pressure and fewer customer acquisition opportunities. / Keith Snyder

March 25, 2022

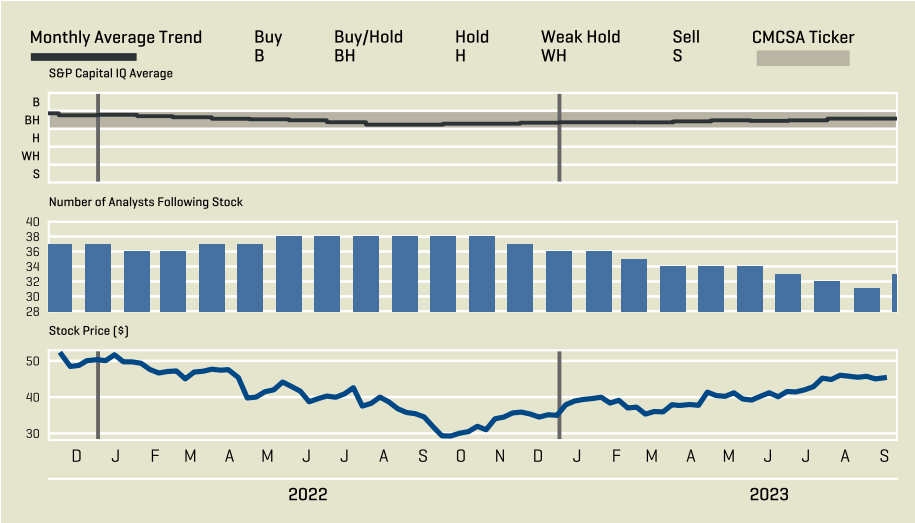
09:02 AM ET... CFRA Adds Comcast Corporation to Total Return Model Portfolio [CMCSA 47.00****]:

We add Comcast to the portfolio on a view that the market underappreciates its long-term growth potential, as well as an excellent dividend history -- current yield of 2.31% and dividend increases every year since initiating in 2008, including recession years of 2009 and 2020. We think Comcast's unique and valuable integration of a market leading broadband provider with NBCUniversal media assets will generate at least market rate long-term earnings growth. This makes Comcast's highly discounted forward P/E multiple of 13x consensus highly attractive vs. S&P 500 at 20x. Barriers around Comcast's primary Cable Communications segment are stronger than once thought, in our view, as it grew customer accounts by 1.1M Y/Y in Q4, despite cable cord-cutting trend and the likes of Google Fiber and SpaceX's Starlink trying to take share in internet service since 2012 and 2015, respectively. Comcast replaces General Dynamics in the Total Return portfolio. Since entry on 5/4/2020, GD has returned 93% to the S&P 500's 59%. / Colin Scarola, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

Comcast Corporation

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	15	45	14	14
Buy/Hold	4	12	4	5
Hold	13	39	12	12
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	1
No Opinion	1	3	1	1
Total	33	100	31	33

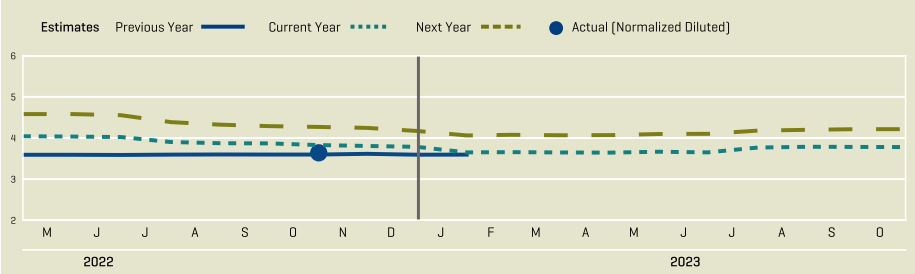
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that CMCSA will earn USD 3.78. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that CMCSA's earnings per share will grow by 11.49% to USD 4.21.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	4.21	4.54	3.78	28	10.22
2023	3.78	3.92	3.51	29	11.40
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 11%	▲ 16%	▲ 8%	▼ -3%	▼ -10%
Q3'24	1.04	1.16	0.92	5	41.39
Q3'23	0.95	1.00	0.90	22	45.35
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	▲ 10%	▲ 16%	▲ 3%	▼ -77%	▼ -9%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.
Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Comcast Corporation

Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsize the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



Comcast Corporation

Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section seof the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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Comcast Corporation

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